

# Rath RPG

## Players Handbook



Erratic Eye Games

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Thank you for playing Rath RPG!

# Rath RPG Players Handbook

## 1. What is Rath RPG?

Rath is a rules-light fantasy roleplaying game. You play adventurers exploring dangerous places, fighting monsters, and getting into trouble. The rules stay out of your way so you can focus on what your character does, not what the rulebook allows.

**The game is dangerous.** Characters can die. Smart play, teamwork, and knowing when to run matter more than character builds. There are no balanced encounters—some fights are unwinnable, and that’s intentional.

**Characters are simple.** You’re defined by three things:

- **Stats** — Six numbers that determine what you’re good at
- **Aptitudes** — Special abilities from training or innate nature
- **Inventory** — What you carry, including equipped spells

**Keywords** tie your choices together. They’re narrative descriptors (Dwarf, Fighter, Sailor) that justify advantage when relevant and help define who you are in the world.

**This book is fantasy, but the rules aren’t.** Sections 2 through 5 don’t know what century you’re in — only the aptitude lists and the equipment do. **Appendix A** swaps those for the modern day and **Appendix B** for science fiction, and Section 7 covers running a game that uses more than one. Start here either way: fantasy is the setting these rules assume, and the easiest one to subtract from.

## 2. The Basics

### Tests

When you attempt something uncertain with consequences, roll a **test**:

**d20 + relevant stat ≥ DC**

The default target is **DC 12**. Meet or beat the DC to succeed (12+ with no modifier).

- **Natural 20**: Critical success — something extra good happens
- **Natural 1**: Critical failure — something goes wrong

Most things in Rath use this same roll. Attack a goblin? d20 + STR vs its armor. Pick a lock? d20 + DEX vs DC 12. Convince a guard? d20 + CHA vs DC 12.

**Variable Targets:** The DC 12 default applies to general tests. Combat rolls target the enemy’s AC instead.

# The Six Stats

| Stat       | Used For                                           |
|------------|----------------------------------------------------|
| <b>STR</b> | Melee attacks, lifting, breaking, physical power   |
| <b>DEX</b> | Ranged attacks, dodging, climbing, sneaking        |
| <b>INT</b> | Magic, resisting magic, recalling lore, crafting   |
| <b>WIS</b> | Perception, tracking, navigation, finding secrets  |
| <b>CON</b> | Resisting poison/sickness, added to healing and HP |
| <b>CHA</b> | Persuasion, deception, intimidation, charm         |

Stats typically range from 0 to 3 using the standard array, or 1 to 6 if rolling. They can reach up to 10 at high levels.

# The Advantage Scale

Tests exist on a four-step scale:

**Impossible → Disadvantage → Straight Roll → Advantage**

| Step                 | How to Roll       | When It Applies                                        |
|----------------------|-------------------|--------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Impossible</b>    | Can't attempt     | No tools, no training, physically can't be done        |
| <b>Disadvantage</b>  | 2d20, take lower  | Poor conditions, injuries, working against your nature |
| <b>Straight Roll</b> | 1d20              | Default for most tests                                 |
| <b>Advantage</b>     | 2d20, take higher | Keywords apply, aptitudes help, favorable conditions   |

**Moving on the Scale:** - Keywords, aptitudes, good tools, and clever tactics move you **up** - Poor conditions, missing tools, and injuries move you **down** - Each factor moves you one step (a keyword moves you from straight to advantage, or from disadvantage to straight)

**Stacking:** Multiple factors in the same direction don't stack beyond one step—you can't get "double advantage." But a factor that would grant advantage can cancel out a disadvantage, moving you back to a straight roll.

**Cancellation:** If you have factors pushing both up and down, they cancel one-for-one. One advantage and one disadvantage = straight roll.

# Fortune Points

Fortune points let you push your luck. **Maximum 3.**

**To use:** After rolling any test, spend 1 Fortune to reroll and keep the higher result. You can spend Fortune on an ally's roll if you're in position to help—describe how.

**Earning Fortune:** - Start each session with 1 - Gain 1 when you roll a natural 20 - GM may award for heroic moments

# Understanding "L"

Throughout this book, "**L**" means your character level.

"L times per long rest" means once at level 1, twice at level 2, and so on. "Ld6 damage" means 1d6 at level 1, 2d6 at level 2, etc.

### 3. Creating a Character

Here's what you'll do:

1. **Choose 2 Aptitudes** — Your special abilities
2. **Choose Keywords** — Species, role, and optionally background
3. **Assign Stats** — Distribute numbers or roll them
4. **Calculate Derived Stats** — HP, AC, and inventory slots
5. **Choose Equipment** — Pick a pack or roll for gear

That's it. You can be ready to play in ten minutes.

### 4. Building Your Character

#### Step 1: Choose Aptitudes

Choose **2 aptitudes** from the list below. These define what your character can do that others can't.

**Skill Aptitudes** are learned abilities—anyone can take them.

**Inherent Aptitudes** are innate traits that define your nature.

**Your aptitude choices determine your species:** - 2 Skill Aptitudes = Human - 1+ Inherent Aptitudes = Demihuman (Dwarf, Elf, Halfling, Beastfolk, etc.)

**Aptitude Precedence:** When an aptitude contradicts a general rule in this book, the aptitude takes precedence. Specific always beats general.

**Playing modern or science fiction?** Use the aptitude list in **Appendix A** or **Appendix B** instead of the one below. Everything else in this section works unchanged.

#### *Skill Aptitudes*

- **Melee Combat**
  - **Cleave:** Reduce enemy to 0 HP → free attack on another enemy in close range. Chain until you miss, run out of targets, or reach L attacks
  - **Protect:** Ally in close range hit → intercept as reaction, take the damage. With shield: CON test DC 12 for half damage
  - **Resilient:** +2 HP per level. Advantage vs stunned/dazed/unconscious
  - **Duelist:** Crit range 18-20. Advantage when fighting 1-on-1
  - **Second Wind:** Once per short rest, action to recover L × 1d6 HP
  - **Berserker:** L times/long rest, rage as free action. While raging: +1 melee damage, advantage on STR tests. Ends when combat ends or you choose
- **Ranged Combat**
  - **Hawkeye:** Miss with bow → next attack has advantage
  - **Marksman:** Action to aim (give up attack) → next ranged attack has advantage + 1d6 damage
- **Assassin**

- **Backstab:** Attack unaware target or with advantage → dagger deals extra damage dice (1 die at L1-4, 2 dice at L5-8, 3 dice at L9-10)
- **Dagger Master:** Always have a dagger. Only dagger (no shield/other weapons): +1 AC, advantage vs larger weapons once per combat
- **Exploration**
  - **Break and Enter:** Advantage to pick locks and disable traps with thieves' tools. Complex traps/locks: roll normally. Can attempt without tools at disadvantage
  - **Move Silently and Unseen:** Advantage to sneak, hide, move quietly, remain undetected
  - **Wild Walker:** Advantage to track, hunt, forage, navigate in natural wilderness
  - **Dungeon Sense:** Advantage to detect traps, secret doors, unusual construction. Learn trap details when searching. Know depth and direction underground
- **Social**
  - **Silver Tongue:** Advantage on CHA to negotiate, improve reactions, convince (not against core interests)
- **Divine**
  - **Heal:** Once per short rest, tend creature 10 minutes → heal (L+1)d6 + WIS HP
  - **Turn Undead:** L times/long rest, WIS test DC 12 → undead in near range with HD ≤ 2d6 + L flee for 1d4 rounds
- **Magic**
  - **Hedge Magic:** Minor magical tricks. INT test DC 12 to use (failure = nothing happens, no cost).
    - **Candlelight:** Floating light illuminates close range, lasts 1 hour
    - **Spark:** Ignite flammables or create small flame in palm
    - **Mend:** Repair small broken non-magical object (1 minute)
    - **Freshen:** Clean, warm, chill, or remove odors from touched object/creature
    - **Trick:** Minor sensory effect—small sound, puff of smoke, brief shimmer
  - **Chartomancer:** Cast spells from scrolls. When you cast from a scroll, make an INT test DC 12 to preserve it—success means the scroll survives, failure destroys it. Advantage if INT > scroll level, disadvantage if INT < scroll level. Casting requires both hands and can be interrupted (if hit while casting, INT test DC 12 or spell fails and scroll is destroyed). Scrolls take 1 inventory slot each. Start with one level 1 scroll of your choice.

## ***Inherent Aptitudes***

*These define what your character IS, not what they've learned.*

- **Sensory**
  - **Darkvision:** See near distance in pitch darkness
  - **NightVision:** See like daytime if any light exists (starlight counts). Not in total darkness
- **Physical**
  - **Natural Weapons:** Claws, teeth, spines. 1d6 + STR damage
  - **Natural Armor:** Scales, plates, hide. +2 AC. Can't wear manufactured armor. Can use shields
  - **Small:** Tiny (object-sized). Advantage to hide and fit through tight spaces. Ride medium creatures. -3 inventory slots (minimum 7). Weapons deal one die size smaller (d8→d6, d6→d4, minimum d4). **With Wings: true flight**
  - **Wings:** Glide short distances, break falls. Can't fly alone. **With Small: true flight**
- **Combat**
  - **Tough:** Advantage on STR tests

- **Shifty:** Larger enemy misses → force them to attack another target in range (may target self)
- **Hard to Pin Down:** Advantage on opposed DEX tests
- **Underfoot:** Move through spaces of larger creatures. Larger enemies have disadvantage on opportunity attacks against you

### *Suggested Combinations*

| Concept            | Aptitudes                       | Result                         |
|--------------------|---------------------------------|--------------------------------|
| <b>Fighter</b>     | Cleave + Resilient              | Tough melee combatant          |
| <b>Thief</b>       | Break and Enter + Move Silently | Classic rogue                  |
| <b>Ranger</b>      | Hawkeye + Wild Walker           | Wilderness archer              |
| <b>Cleric</b>      | Heal + Turn Undead              | Divine protector               |
| <b>Barbarian</b>   | Berserker + Resilient           | Raging warrior                 |
| <b>Assassin</b>    | Backstab + Dagger Master        | Lethal striker                 |
| <b>Hedge Witch</b> | Hedge Magic + Silver Tongue     | Minor magic and charm          |
| <b>Arcanist</b>    | Chartomancer + Dungeon Sense    | Scroll-casting treasure hunter |
| Demihuman          | Aptitudes                       | Result                         |
| <b>Dwarf</b>       | Darkvision + Tough              | Underground survivor           |
| <b>Elf</b>         | NightVision + Hard to Pin Down  | Graceful and elusive           |
| <b>Halfling</b>    | Underfoot + Shifty              | Nimble and tricky              |
| <b>Pixie</b>       | Small + Wings                   | True flight, tiny              |
| <b>Beastfolk</b>   | Natural Weapons + Natural Armor | Claws and hide                 |
| <b>Goblin</b>      | NightVision + Underfoot         | Sneaky tunnel-dweller          |

## Step 2: Choose Keywords

Choose **2-3 keywords** that describe your character:

1. **Species** (Required): Human, Dwarf, Elf, Orc, Halfling, Construct, Pixie, etc.
2. **Role** (Required): Fighter, Thief, Wizard, Ranger, Cleric, Barbarian, etc.
3. **Background** (Optional): Noble, Outlaw, Sailor, Merchant, Soldier, etc.

**Using Keywords:** When a keyword is relevant, you can argue for advantage. “As a Ranger, I should have advantage tracking this beast.” If the GM agrees, you get it.

Keywords are narrative, not mechanical. They describe who you are and open doors to advantage when it makes sense.

## Step 3: Assign Stats

Choose **one method**:

### **Method 1: Plan Ahead**

Distribute these values among your six stats: **3, 2, 2, 1, 1, 0**

Put your highest number in the stat most important to your concept.

## Method 2: Roll the Bones

Roll **3d6** for each stat in order (STR, DEX, INT, WIS, CON, CHA).

The **lowest die** = that stat's value.

When done, you may **swap any two stats**.

## Step 4: Calculate Derived Stats

| Stat                    | Formula                |
|-------------------------|------------------------|
| <b>HP</b> (Hit Points)  | 10 + CON               |
| <b>AC</b> (Armor Class) | 10 + DEX + armor bonus |
| <b>Inventory Slots</b>  | 10 + CON               |

Some aptitudes modify these (Resilient adds +2 HP per level, Natural Armor adds +2 AC, Small reduces inventory slots).

## Step 5: Choose Equipment

**Playing modern or science fiction?** Use the gear packs and equipment in **Appendix A** or **Appendix B**. The slot and damage maths are the same either way.

### Option A: Pick a Gear Pack

All packs include **rations (UD8)** and **2d6+5 copper pieces**.

| Pack              | Contents                                                                                        |
|-------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Combat</b>     | Medium armor (+2 AC, 3 slots), standard weapon (d8, 2 slots), shield (+1 AC, 1 slot), torches   |
| <b>Scout</b>      | Light armor (+1 AC, 2 slots), bow (d6, 2 slots), dagger (d6, 1 slot), rope 50ft, lantern        |
| <b>Caster</b>     | Staff (d6, 1 slot), candles, blank book, tinderbox, lantern                                     |
| <b>Specialist</b> | Light armor (+1 AC, 2 slots), 2 daggers (d6, 1 slot each), lockpicks, rope 50ft, grappling hook |

### Option B: Roll for Equipment

*Weapon (choose one):*

| Type                             | Damage | Slots | Notes                                     |
|----------------------------------|--------|-------|-------------------------------------------|
| Simple (dagger, club, staff)     | d6     | 1     |                                           |
| Standard (sword, axe, spear)     | d8     | 2     | d10 if two-handed                         |
| Two-handed (halberd, war hammer) | d10    | 3     | Knock prone on crit                       |
| Bow                              | d6     | 2     | Far range                                 |
| Crossbow                         | d8     | 3     | Far range, ignores 2 AC, action to reload |

*Armor (roll d20):*

| 1-3      | 4-14                   | 15-20                   |
|----------|------------------------|-------------------------|
| No armor | Light (+1 AC, 2 slots) | Medium (+2 AC, 3 slots) |



*Helmet and Shield (roll d20):*

| 1-13 | 14-16                  | 17-19                  | 20                    |
|------|------------------------|------------------------|-----------------------|
| None | Helmet (+1 AC, 1 slot) | Shield (+1 AC, 1 slot) | Both (+2 AC, 2 slots) |

*Adventuring Gear:* Roll twice on Dungeoneering, once on General 1, once on General 2. (See Equipment Reference at end of this book.)

## Step 6: Traits (Optional)

Add personality by rolling or choosing:

| d20 | Physique   | Speech     | Virtue      | Vice       |
|-----|------------|------------|-------------|------------|
| 1   | Athletic   | Blunt      | Ambitious   | Aggressive |
| 2   | Brawny     | Booming    | Cautious    | Arrogant   |
| 3   | Corpulent  | Breathy    | Courageous  | Bitter     |
| 4   | Delicate   | Cryptic    | Courteous   | Cowardly   |
| 5   | Gaunt      | Drawling   | Curious     | Cruel      |
| 6   | Hulking    | Droning    | Disciplined | Deceitful  |
| 7   | Lanky      | Flowery    | Focused     | Flippant   |
| 8   | Ripped     | Formal     | Generous    | Gluttonous |
| 9   | Rugged     | Gravelly   | Gregarious  | Greedy     |
| 10  | Scrawny    | Hoarse     | Honest      | Irascible  |
| 11  | Short      | Mumbling   | Honorable   | Lazy       |
| 12  | Sinewy     | Precise    | Humble      | Nervous    |
| 13  | Slender    | Quaint     | Idealistic  | Prejudiced |
| 14  | Flabby     | Rambling   | Just        | Reckless   |
| 15  | Statuesque | Rapid-fire | Loyal       | Rude       |
| 16  | Stout      | Dialect    | Merciful    | Suspicious |
| 17  | Tiny       | Slow       | Righteous   | Vain       |
| 18  | Towering   | Squeaky    | Serene      | Vengeful   |
| 19  | Willowy    | Stuttering | Stoic       | Wasteful   |
| 20  | Wiry       | Whispery   | Tolerant    | Whiny      |

## 5. Playing the Game

### Combat

**Initiative:** Each round, all PCs roll **d20 + DEX vs DC 12**.

- **Success (12+):** You act before monsters
- **Failure:** You act after monsters

Reroll each round.

**Turn order:** Successful PCs → Monsters → Failed PCs

**Ultra-simple variant:** Roll 1d6 instead. On 1-3, enemies act first. On 4-6, players act first.

**On Your Turn:** - **Move** up to near distance + **take an action** (attack, cast, use item, etc.) - OR **Run** up to far distance (no action)

**Attacking:** Roll d20 + STR (melee) or DEX (ranged) vs target's AC. Meet or beat AC to hit.

**Damage:** Roll your weapon's damage die. Add STR to melee damage.

**Exploding Damage:** When you roll maximum on a damage die, roll again and add. Keep rolling if you keep hitting max.

**Critical Hit (Natural 20):** Target loses 1 AC until combat ends.

**Fumble (Natural 1):** Something goes wrong—drop weapon, slip, enemy gets advantage next attack. GM decides.

## Combat Maneuvers

**Two Weapons:** After your first attack, make a second with disadvantage.

**Sacrifice Shield:** Destroy your shield to absorb up to 15 damage.

**Stunts:** Shove, disarm, trip, etc. Resolved with opposed tests (usually STR vs STR or DEX vs DEX).

## Reactions

Some abilities let you act outside your turn as a **reaction**. You get one reaction per round. Common reactions:

- **Protect** (aptitude): Intercept an attack on a nearby ally
- **Opportunity Attack:** When an enemy leaves your reach, make one free attack

## Distance

| Abstract | Specific | Notes                   |
|----------|----------|-------------------------|
| Close    | 5-10 ft  | Melee range             |
| Near     | 20-30 ft | One move, bow range     |
| Far      | 40-60 ft | Running distance        |
| Distant  | 60+ ft   | Beyond immediate combat |

**Moving.** On your turn you may move up to **Near**, or give up your action to run up to **Far**. Anything that halves your speed covers half as much ground — two moves to go where one normally takes you.

**Optional: measured distances.** For a table using miniatures or a grid, use feet throughout instead of the ladder above, and stay on one system for the whole fight. A move is **30 ft** and a run is **60 ft**. Close is adjacent (5 ft), Near is 30 ft, Far is 60 ft, and Distant is anything past that. A weapon's range trait uses the same figures — a Near-range weapon reaches 30 ft, a Far-range one 60 ft — so no equipment list changes with it.

## Injury and Death

**Dropping to 0 HP:** Make a CON test DC 12. - **Success:** Adrenaline rush! Gain 1d6 HP and keep fighting. - **Failure:** Out of action. Can only crawl. Can't act or be tended until danger passes.

**When Danger Passes:** Roll 2d6 on the Critical Injury Table:

| 2d6   | Result                                                        |
|-------|---------------------------------------------------------------|
| 2-3   | <b>Dead</b> — Make your final words count                     |
| 4-6   | <b>Maimed</b> — Permanent injury (GM determines). Gain 1d6 HP |
| 7-9   | <b>Broken</b> — Need 1 week bed rest. Gain 1d6 HP             |
| 10-11 | <b>Battered</b> — Need 1 day rest. Gain 1d6 HP                |
| 12    | <b>Tough Bastard</b> — Gain 2d6 HP, return to action!         |

## Conditions

Hazards like poison, fire, and disease inflict **conditions**—ongoing effects that persist until cured or fought off. Your GM tracks condition severity and tells you when to roll saves or take damage. Common conditions include poisoned, burning, bleeding, and diseased.

## Rest and Recovery

**Short Rest** (1 hour in relative safety): - Recover 1d6 + CON HP - Use abilities that recharge on short rest

**Long Rest** (6-8 hours of sleep in safe location): - Recover full HP - All abilities recharge - Can spend XP to level up

## Advancement

**Earning XP:** Gain 1 XP per session where something substantial happened.

**Leveling Up:** Spend XP equal to your current level during a long rest. - Level 1→2: 1 XP - Level 2→3: 2 XP - Level 3→4: 3 XP - (and so on...)

**When You Level Up:**

1. **Increase One Stat:** +1 to any stat. No stat above 10 or above Level + 2.
2. **Gain Aptitude (at levels 3, 5, 7, 9):** Choose from Basic Aptitudes or ask your GM about Advanced options. Maximum 6 aptitudes total.
3. **Roll for HP:** Roll d8s equal to new level + CON. If higher than current max, that's your new max. If equal or lower, add 1 to current max.

# 6. Equipment Reference

*This is the fantasy equipment list. For modern or science fiction gear, see **Appendix A** or **Appendix B** — they use the same scales, so items from any of the three can sit in the same inventory.*

## Currency

- **Copper pieces (cp)**: Common coin
- **Silver pieces (sp)**: 1 sp = 10 cp
- **Gold pieces (gp)**: 1 gp = 100 cp = 10 sp

## Inventory Slots

Your inventory holds **10 + CON** slots.

Unless a table says otherwise, **an item takes 1 slot. 100 coins fill one slot.** The GM is the final arbiter on anything ambiguous.

## Weapons

| Weapon          | Damage | Slots | Cost  | Notes                     |
|-----------------|--------|-------|-------|---------------------------|
| Dagger          | d6     | 1     | 3 cp  | Throwable (near)          |
| Club/Staff      | d6     | 1     | 1 cp  |                           |
| Sword/Axe/Spear | d8     | 2     | 10 cp | d10 two-handed            |
| Two-handed      | d10    | 3     | 20 cp | Prone on crit             |
| Sling           | d4     | 1     | 1 cp  | Near range                |
| Bow             | d6     | 2     | 25 cp | Far range                 |
| Crossbow        | d8     | 3     | 30 cp | Far, ignores 2 AC, reload |

### *Building a Weapon*

The table above is the fantasy list. The scale underneath it prices anything.

| Damage     | Slots | What it is                               |
|------------|-------|------------------------------------------|
| <b>d4</b>  | 1     | Improvised, or a hold-out weapon         |
| <b>d6</b>  | 1     | Small, light, or one-handed              |
| <b>d8</b>  | 2     | Standard — an arming weapon or a sidearm |
| <b>d10</b> | 3     | Heavy, or two-handed                     |

Every weapon gets **one trait free**. Each additional trait costs **+1 slot, or one step down the damage die**.

| Trait                | Effect                                          |
|----------------------|-------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Ranged (near)</b> | Attack to near distance, using DEX              |
| <b>Ranged (far)</b>  | Attack to far distance, using DEX               |
| <b>Reload</b>        | Action to reload after a set number of shots    |
| <b>Piercing</b>      | Ignores 2 AC                                    |
| <b>Throwable</b>     | Can be thrown to near distance                  |
| <b>Concealable</b>   | Hidden under clothing without a test            |
| <b>Quiet</b>         | Doesn't give away your position on a hit        |
| <b>Burst</b>         | Two targets in near range, both at disadvantage |

A bow checks out: d6, 2 slots, and its free trait spent on far range. So does a crossbow: d8, far range free, *piercing* paid for with the third slot, *reload* paid for by being a heavy thing to carry.

**d10 is the ceiling** for anything a character picks up and uses. Above it, something must pay — a round spent aiming, an ammunition limit, rarity, or an aptitude requirement. This holds across every appendix in this book; it is what lets a sword and a rifle share a table.

**The GM is the final arbiter.** If a player describes a weapon that isn’t on any list, price it here and get on with the game.

Armor

| Armor  | AC Bonus | Slots | Cost   | Notes                     |
|--------|----------|-------|--------|---------------------------|
| Light  | +1       | 2     | 20 cp  |                           |
| Medium | +2       | 3     | 60 cp  | Disadvantage stealth      |
| Heavy  | +3       | 5     | 120 cp | Disadvantage stealth/swim |
| Shield | +1       | 1     | 10 cp  | Can sacrifice for 15 DR   |
| Helmet | +1       | 1     | 10 cp  |                           |

Usage Dice

Some supplies track depletion with usage dice:

**d20 → d12 → d10 → d8 → d6 → d4 → depleted**

When you use the item, roll its usage die. On 1-2, decrease die size. When d4 rolls 1-2, item is gone.

- Ammunition: Roll once after combat
- Light sources: Roll every hour

Adventuring Gear

*The common kit — what most characters buy first. Every item here is priced in this table and nowhere else in the book.*

| Item            | Cost | Slots |
|-----------------|------|-------|
| Rations (UD8)   | 1 sp | 1     |
| Torch (UD6)     | 1 cp | 1     |
| Candle (UD8)    | 1 cp | 1     |
| Lantern         | 3 sp | 1     |
| Lamp Oil (UD8)  | 5 cp | 1     |
| Tinderbox       | 1 sp | 1     |
| Rope 50ft       | 1 sp | 1     |
| Grappling hook  | 1 sp | 1     |
| Thieves’ tools  | 1 gp | 1     |
| Crowbar         | 1 sp | 1     |
| Hammer + spikes | 2 sp | 1     |
| Pole 10ft       | 5 cp | 1     |
| Steel Mirror    | 5 cp | -     |

| Item                  | Cost  | Slots |
|-----------------------|-------|-------|
| Waterskin             | 5 cp  | 1     |
| Scribe's Vellum (UD6) | 50 cp | 1     |
| Quill & Ink (UD8)     | 20 cp | 1     |

**Writing medium and marking tool:** in a fantasy game these are Scribe's Vellum and Quill & Ink. Aptitudes that need them — the **Scribe** aptitude in *Advanced Aptitudes*, for one — name the function rather than the object, so each setting supplies its own.

## Tools & Gear

*Everything else money can buy. Items from the kit list above are not repeated here.*

| Item             | Price |  | Item                        | Price       |
|------------------|-------|--|-----------------------------|-------------|
| Air Bladder      | 5 cp  |  | Lens                        | 1 gp        |
| Bear Trap        | 2 sp  |  | Manacles                    | 1 sp        |
| Bedroll          | 1 sp  |  | Marbles (UD8)               | 5 cp        |
| Bellows          | 1 sp  |  | Metal File                  | 5 cp        |
| Black Grease     | 1 cp  |  | Mirror (glass)              | 2 gp        |
| Block and Tackle | 3 sp  |  | Musical Instrument          | 2 gp        |
| Book (Blank)     | 3 gp  |  | Nails (UD8)                 | 5 cp        |
| Book (Reading)   | 6 gp  |  | Net                         | 1 sp        |
| Bottle/Vial      | 1 cp  |  | Oilskin Bag                 | 5 cp        |
| Bucket           | 5 cp  |  | Oilskin Trousers            | 1 sp        |
| Caltrops (UD4)   | 1 sp  |  | Padlock and Key             | 2 sp        |
| Chain (10 ft)    | 1 sp  |  | Perfume                     | 5 sp        |
| Chalk (UD6)      | 1 cp  |  | Pick                        | 1 sp        |
| Chisel           | 5 cp  |  | Sack                        | 1 cp        |
| Cookpots         | 1 sp  |  | Saw                         | 1 sp        |
| Drill            | 1 sp  |  | Shovel                      | 1 sp        |
| Face Paint (UD8) | 1 sp  |  | Small Bell                  | 2 sp        |
| Fake Jewels      | 5 sp  |  | Soap                        | 1 cp        |
| Fishing Rod      | 1 sp  |  | Spike (iron)                | 5 cp        |
| Glue (UD6)       | 1 cp  |  | Spike (wood)                | 1 cp        |
| Hammer           | 1 sp  |  | Spiked Boots                | 5 cp        |
| Holy Water       | 3 sp  |  | Spyglass                    | 10 gp       |
| Horn             | 1 sp  |  | Tar (UD8)                   | 1 sp        |
| Hourglass        | 3 gp  |  | Tent (3 man)                | 1 gp        |
| Incense          | 1 sp  |  | Tent (personal)             | 5 sp        |
| Iron Tongs       | 1 sp  |  | Twine (300 ft)              | 5 cp        |
| Ladder (10 ft)   | 1 sp  |  | Whistle                     | 5 cp        |
| Large Sponge     | 5 cp  |  | <b>Healing Potion (UD6)</b> | <b>5 gp</b> |

**Thieves' Tools:** Required for picking locks and disabling traps. Break on failed attempt by 5+.

# Light

Light sources are priced under Adventuring Gear. This table is how they behave.

| Item           | Range | Notes                |
|----------------|-------|----------------------|
| Candle (UD8)   | Close | Extinguished by wind |
| Lantern        | Near  | Protected flame      |
| Torch (UD6)    | Near  | Can ignite things    |
| Lamp Oil (UD8) | —     | Refills a lantern    |
| Tinderbox      | —     | Lights fires         |

# Poisons & Antitoxins

| Item                 | Price | Notes                  |
|----------------------|-------|------------------------|
| Antitoxin (Basic)    | 5 gp  | Remove 2d6 from poison |
| Antitoxin (Superior) | 20 gp | Remove 4d6 from poison |
| Poison, Weak         | 10 gp | 4d6 poison             |
| Poison, Moderate     | 20 gp | 6d6 poison             |
| Poison, Strong       | 40 gp | 8d6 poison             |
| Poison, Lethal       | 80 gp | 10d6 poison, illegal   |

**Warning:** Requires Poison Use aptitude to apply safely. 1 dose coats weapon for 3 attacks. Illegal in most areas.

# Clothing

| Item     | Price | Notes                  |
|----------|-------|------------------------|
| Poor     | 1 sp  | Peasant, beggar        |
| Standard | 5 sp  | Traveler, merchant     |
| Winter   | 1 gp  | Protection from cold   |
| Noble    | 30 gp | Access to high society |
| Exotic   | 40 gp | Foreign, eye-catching  |
| Furs     | 50 gp | Luxury, warmth         |

# Food & Lodging

| Item              | Price |  | Item           | Price |
|-------------------|-------|--|----------------|-------|
| Animal Feed (UD8) | 4 cp  |  | Bed, per night | 1 cp  |
| Bread, loaf       | 1 cp  |  | Private room   | 2 cp  |
| Cheese, 1 lb      | 2 cp  |  | Hot bath       | 2 cp  |
| Wine/Ale, bottle  | 1 cp  |  | Stabling       | 2 cp  |
| Meal              | 2 cp  |  |                |       |

# Animals & Transport

| Item          | Price  | Inventory Slots |
|---------------|--------|-----------------|
| Donkey/Mule   | 3 gp   | 20 slots        |
| Horse, riding | 10 gp  | 10 slots        |
| Horse, war    | 100 gp | 10 slots        |
| Dog, hunting  | 5 sp   | -               |
| Hawk          | 10 gp  | -               |
| Cart          | 5 sp   | 2x animal       |

| Item     | Price | Inventory Slots |
|----------|-------|-----------------|
| Wagon    | 2 gp  | 3x animals      |
| Carriage | 4 gp  | 3x animals      |

**Vehicles:** A cart doubles the pulling animal's capacity. A wagon or carriage triples the combined capacity of two animals. Example: Two mules (20 each) pulling a wagon = 120 slots.

## Random Gear Tables

### Dungeoneering Gear (d20)

| d20 | Item           | d20 | Item         |
|-----|----------------|-----|--------------|
| 1   | Rope 50ft      | 11  | Lantern      |
| 2   | Pulleys        | 12  | Lamp oil     |
| 3   | Candles (5)    | 13  | Padlock      |
| 4   | Chain 10ft     | 14  | Manacles     |
| 5   | Chalk (10)     | 15  | Steel mirror |
| 6   | Crowbar        | 16  | Pole 10ft    |
| 7   | Tinderbox      | 17  | Sack         |
| 8   | Grappling hook | 18  | Tent         |
| 9   | Hammer         | 19  | Spikes       |
| 10  | Waterskin      | 20  | Torches      |

### General Gear 1 (d20)

| d20 | Item        | d20 | Item        |
|-----|-------------|-----|-------------|
| 1   | Air bladder | 11  | Fake jewels |
| 2   | Bear trap   | 12  | Blank book  |
| 3   | Shovel      | 13  | Card deck   |
| 4   | Bellows     | 14  | Dice set    |
| 5   | Grease      | 15  | Cook pots   |
| 6   | Saw         | 16  | Face paint  |
| 7   | Bucket      | 17  | Whistle     |
| 8   | Caltrops    | 18  | Instrument  |
| 9   | Chisel      | 19  | Quill & ink |
| 10  | Drill       | 20  | Small bell  |

### General Gear 2 (d20)

| d20 | Item     | d20 | Item        |
|-----|----------|-----|-------------|
| 1   | Incense  | 11  | Fishing rod |
| 2   | Sponge   | 12  | Marbles     |
| 3   | Lens     | 13  | Glue        |
| 4   | Perfume  | 14  | Pick        |
| 5   | Horn     | 15  | Hourglass   |
| 6   | Bottle   | 16  | Net         |
| 7   | Soap     | 17  | Tongs       |
| 8   | Spyglass | 18  | Lockpicks   |
| 9   | Tar pot  | 19  | Metal file  |
| 10  | Twine    | 20  | Nails       |



## 7. Mixing Settings

This book is fantasy. The two appendices behind it are modern and science fiction, and they are not separate games — they are parts bins for this one.

Everything in Sections 2 through 5 is genre-blind. The stats, the DCs, the advantage scale, the damage and slot scales, the injury table: none of it knows or cares what century you're in. Only three things change between settings — the **aptitude list**, the **keyword suggestions**, and the **equipment**. That's what the appendices hold, and it's why you can take from them freely without converting anything.

**How to do it:** decide what your game is about, then pull the pieces that serve it. Tell your players which appendices are on the table before character creation. That's the whole procedure.

### Fantasy is the default for a reason

It isn't tradition. It's that fantasy characters have a **small information horizon** — everything past a day's walk is rumour, so the GM can invent it at the table and no one can check. That's what makes improvised play work, and it's the thing the other two settings have to work around rather than inherit. Each appendix says how.

Fantasy is also the superset. Hedge Magic and Chartomancy are in this book; the Circles are one supplement away. A modern or science fiction game run on these rules will have something strange in it whether you plan for it or not — and if you'd rather it didn't, ignoring the magic aptitudes costs you nothing. Start here and subtract, rather than starting elsewhere and trying to add.

### Worked examples

**Magic in the modern day.** Run Appendix A for gear, occupations, and money. Add the Circle of Magic from *Advanced Magic* for characters who have it. Firearms and spellcasting already share a damage scale, so a pistol and a Conjure Flame sit in the same fight without anyone doing sums. The interesting question stops being *does this balance* and becomes *who knows magic is real*.

**A traveller from elsewhere.** The party is this book. One character is Appendix A or B — modern or far-future aptitudes, a sidearm with a hard ammunition limit, and gear nobody else can repair. The usage die is the whole story: every roll on that pistol brings them closer to being just another person in a strange place. Give them the **Stranded** keyword and let it earn advantage on knowing things and disadvantage on being trusted.

**Post-apocalypse.** Not an appendix at all — an assembly. Take Appendix A's gear and lethality, Appendix B's technology as ruins and salvage rather than equipment, and this book's foraging, travel, and light economy, which is the part that actually makes a wasteland feel like one. Scarcity comes free: run every consumable one usage die smaller than listed. A whole setting, and you wrote none of it.

**Anything else.** Weird West is this book's frontier travel with Appendix A's revolvers. Gaslamp horror is Appendix A held to this book's light rules. A generation ship is Appendix B with this book's exploration aptitudes, because a derelict deck is a dungeon. The seams are meant to be pulled at.

## One thing to watch

Hold the line at **d10** for weapon damage unless something is paying for the excess. The scale in Section 6 is what keeps a sword and a rifle in the same conversation; a weapon that quietly exceeds it takes the game over. Everything else — aptitudes, keywords, gear, money — mixes freely and needs no adjudication beyond a GM saying yes.

## Appendix A: Modern

*Sirens, streetlights, and something in the storm drain. Roughly the present day — near enough that everyone at the table already knows how the world works.*

**Currency:** prices use the same numbers as Section 6. A copper piece is a **dollar**; 1 sp is ten, 1 gp is a hundred. Call it whatever your setting calls it.

**What changes:** the aptitude list below replaces Step 1's, the keywords replace Step 2's suggestions, and the equipment replaces Section 6's. Sections 2 through 5 are unchanged.

### A1. Aptitudes

Choose **2** at character creation, as normal.

#### Skill Aptitudes

*Occupations — what you did before this, or still do by day.*

- **Detective:** Advantage on tests to examine a scene, follow a paper trail, or read a suspect. Once per long rest, declare an *intuition* — the GM gives you one true fact about a current mystery
- **Medic:** Stabilise a dying character with no test. Once per short rest, ten minutes of care restores 1d6 + WIS HP
- **Mechanic:** Advantage on tests to repair, modify, or sabotage vehicles, electronics, and machinery. Identify the make and condition of unfamiliar equipment on an INT test DC 12
- **Soldier:** No disadvantage with firearms. Advantage on tests to hold composure under fire or read a tactical situation
- **Researcher:** Advantage on INT tests to recall academic knowledge in your field. Once per long rest, declare "*I studied this*" — the GM provides relevant background on a current topic
- **Journalist:** Advantage on CHA tests to get information out of someone in an interview. Once per adventure, name a contact you know in your beat, and they exist
- **Engineer:** Build or jury-rig a working device from what's on hand. INT test DC 12 and ten minutes for something simple — an alarm, a signal, a shaped charge, a weapon

*Talents — competencies layered onto any character.*

- **Driving:** Advantage on DEX tests to handle a car, bike, or boat at speed
- **Firearms:** No disadvantage with handguns, rifles, and shotguns. Quick Draw works with them
- **Computers:** Advantage on INT tests to use, navigate, or break into computer systems. Recognise malware and basic intrusions on sight

- **Streetwise:** Advantage to find black-market goods, locate criminal contacts, or read a neighbourhood’s affiliations
- **Athletics:** Advantage on STR/DEX tests for climbing, running, and moving through built environments at speed
- **Break and Enter:** Advantage to defeat locks and alarms with tools. High-security systems roll normally. Without tools, at disadvantage
- **Move Silently and Unseen:** Advantage to sneak, hide, and remain unnoticed
- **Silver Tongue:** Advantage on CHA to negotiate, de-escalate, or convince — not against someone’s core interests
- **Languages:** Two additional languages. Can be taken more than once

## Inherent Aptitudes

*These work exactly as in Section 4 — most modern characters take two Skill Aptitudes and are ordinary people, which is the point. Take an Inherent Aptitude only if your game has something in it that isn’t.*

Use the Inherent Aptitudes from Section 4 unchanged. **Natural Weapons**, **Natural Armor**, **Darkvision**, and **Tough** describe a werewolf, a revenant, or whatever your game’s strangeness turns out to be, as well as they describe a beastfolk.

## Suggested Combinations

| Concept                         | Aptitudes                       |
|---------------------------------|---------------------------------|
| <b>Homicide detective</b>       | Detective + Firearms            |
| <b>Field medic</b>              | Medic + Soldier                 |
| <b>Getaway driver</b>           | Driving + Streetwise            |
| <b>Investigative journalist</b> | Journalist + Researcher         |
| <b>Burglar</b>                  | Break and Enter + Move Silently |
| <b>Fixer</b>                    | Silver Tongue + Streetwise      |
| <b>Hacker</b>                   | Computers + Engineer            |
| <b>Ex-military contractor</b>   | Soldier + Athletics             |

## A2. Keywords

| Type               | Examples                                                                                        |
|--------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Who you are</b> | Human — and if not, say what. Werewolf, Revenant, Unregistered, Something Else                  |
| <b>Role</b>        | Detective, Nurse, Priest, Soldier, Reporter, Trucker, Student, Criminal                         |
| <b>Background</b>  | Grew Up On The Docks, Old Money, Wanted In Three Counties, Ex-Police, Burned Out, Nobody’s Left |

### A3. Gear Packs

All packs include a **phone**, a **wallet**, and **2d6+5 in cash**.

| Pack   | Contents                                                                                     |
|--------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Badge  | Concealed vest (+1 AC, 2 slots), handgun (d6, 1 slot), cuffs, radio, flashlight              |
| Field  | Tactical vest (+2 AC, 3 slots), rifle (d8, 2 slots), knife (d6, 1 slot), first aid kit, rope |
| Street | Knife (d6, 1 slot), lockpicks, burner phone, crowbar, flashlight                             |
| Desk   | Laptop, camera, voice recorder, notebook, a car that mostly starts                           |

### A4. Equipment

#### Firearms

Guns do not out-damage their medieval equivalents. They out-*trait* them — a bow spends its free trait just reaching far range, while a rifle gets there and can still afford piercing or burst. Same die, three things the bow can't do.

| Weapon        | Damage   | Slots | Cost (\$) | Notes                                                                              |
|---------------|----------|-------|-----------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Handgun       | d6       | 1     | 300       | Near range, concealable                                                            |
| Revolver      | d8       | 2     | 300       | Near range, reload                                                                 |
| Rifle         | d8       | 2     | 500       | Far range                                                                          |
| Hunting rifle | d8       | 3     | 600       | Far range, piercing                                                                |
| Shotgun       | d10 / d6 | 3     | 400       | d10 at close, d6 at near, nothing beyond                                           |
| SMG           | d6       | 2     | 900       | Near range, burst                                                                  |
| Sniper rifle  | d10      | 3     | 2000      | Distant range, piercing. <b>Setup:</b> one round aiming, or attack at disadvantage |
| Suppressor    | —        | —     | 300       | Adds <i>quiet</i> to one firearm. Costs one die step or one slot                   |

**Ammunition** runs on a usage die like anything else — d8 for a loaded weapon, rolled once after each fight. On a natural 1 while firing, the weapon jams; clearing it takes an action.

#### Armour

| Armour         | AC | Slots | Cost (\$) | Notes                                 |
|----------------|----|-------|-----------|---------------------------------------|
| Concealed vest | +1 | 2     | 400       | Hidden under clothing                 |
| Tactical vest  | +2 | 3     | 800       | Visible. Disadvantage on stealth      |
| Plate carrier  | +3 | 5     | 1500      | Disadvantage on stealth and swimming  |
| Riot helmet    | +1 | 1     | 200       |                                       |
| Riot shield    | +1 | 1     | 300       | Can be sacrificed to absorb 15 damage |

#### Gear

| Item      | Cost (\$) |  | Item       | Cost (\$) |
|-----------|-----------|--|------------|-----------|
| Phone     | 300       |  | Flashlight | 20        |
| Handcuffs | 30        |  | Multitool  | 40        |

| Item           | Cost (\$) |  | Item                | Cost (\$) |
|----------------|-----------|--|---------------------|-----------|
| Burner phone   | 20        |  | Radio, pair         | 80        |
| Zip ties (UD8) | 5         |  | Duct tape (UD6)     | 5         |
| Laptop         | 800       |  | First aid kit (UD6) | 50        |
| Rope, 50 ft    | 20        |  | Fuel can (UD8)      | 30        |
| Camera         | 400       |  | Painkillers (UD6)   | 20        |
| Crowbar        | 20        |  | Camera, hidden      | 300       |
| Voice recorder | 50        |  | Body bag            | 30        |
| Bolt cutters   | 40        |  | Fake ID             | 500       |
| Binoculars     | 100       |  | Notebook (UD6)      | 20        |
| Lockpicks      | 100       |  | Pens (UD8)          | 5         |

## Vehicles

| Vehicle     | Cost (\$) | Notes                                              |
|-------------|-----------|----------------------------------------------------|
| Car         | 8000      | Distant in one round on open road. Four passengers |
| Motorcycle  | 4000      | Two passengers. Advantage on Driving in traffic    |
| Van         | 12000     | Slow. 60 slots of cargo, or six people             |
| Boat, small | 15000     |                                                    |

**Light:** a flashlight is near range and a phone screen is close range. Both run on a UD8 rolled each hour. Everything in Section 6’s Light rules otherwise applies — a modern game is not as well-lit as people assume once the power’s out.

## A5. Optional Rules

**Lethal firearms.** The list above keeps guns level with medieval weapons, which suits pulp and horror. For a game where a gunshot is a catastrophe, shift **every** firearm up one die and give non-ballistic armour no AC against them. Apply it to the enemies too — that’s the whole point, and it makes a single hallway genuinely frightening.

**Response time.** Modern settings have police, ambulances, and fire crews. When something loud happens, roll a d6: that’s how many rounds until sirens are audible. This one die does more to shape modern play than any equipment rule.

**Paper trails.** Everything modern characters do leaves a record — cameras, card transactions, phone location. Rather than tracking it, give the GM one **Trace** token each time the party is careless. Spent later, a Trace means someone found them.

## A6. Tone Notes

### The information problem

This is the appendix’s central difficulty and it needs solving at your table before session one.

Fantasy runs on a small information horizon: past a day’s walk, everything is rumour, so the GM invents it and no one can check. Modern characters have a phone. Any mystery you improvise can be dissolved by a player who says “*I look it up.*”

Don't ban the phone. Answer it. Pick whichever fits:

- **No signal.** Basements, tunnels, storms, rural dead zones, deliberate jamming. Cheap, effective, and a reason to keep moving.
- **The record is wrong.** The information exists and it's false — the file was altered, the obituary was printed for someone still alive. Now the search *is* the clue.
- **Access, not knowledge.** They know the file exists. Getting it means a warrant, a favour, or a break-in. The obstacle moves from knowing to reaching.
- **It isn't written down.** The thing they're chasing predates records, or is deliberately absent from them. A search that returns nothing is itself information.

The last one is the best of the four, and it's why modern horror works: the terrifying result is the empty one.

## Everything else

Modern Rath is not action-hero fiction by default. Characters have the same 10 + CON hit points as everyone else, which is two or three shots. The genre this system naturally produces is **crime, investigation, and horror** — people out of their depth in a world that mostly makes sense. Lean into that before you try to make it *Die Hard*.

Ordinary characters are the strength here. A nurse, a mechanic, and a reporter make a better party than three ex-special-forces operators, because the interesting question is what they're willing to do, not what they're able to.

And the world is documented, populated, and legible in a way a fantasy world isn't — which cuts both ways. Your players know how a hospital works, so you don't have to explain it. They also know what *should* happen when someone calls 911, which means the moment nobody comes is worth ten paragraphs of description.

## Appendix B: Science Fiction

*Long distances, thin air, and salvage worth more than the ship. Anywhere from a grimy near-future to the far end of a long expansion.*

**Currency:** prices use the same numbers as Section 6. A copper piece is a **credit**; 1 sp is ten, 1 gp is a hundred.

**What changes:** the aptitude list below replaces Step 1's, the keywords replace Step 2's suggestions, and the equipment replaces Section 6's. Sections 2 through 5 are unchanged.

### B1. Aptitudes

Choose **2** at character creation, as normal.

#### Skill Aptitudes

- **Pilot:** Advantage on DEX tests to fly, dock, or evade in any craft you've been checked out on. Once per long rest, attempt a manoeuvre the GM has called impossible
- **Void-Walker:** Advantage on tests to work in vacuum, zero gravity, or a failing suit. You do

not panic when the seal goes

- **Tech:** Advantage on INT tests to repair, override, or sabotage machinery and software. Identify unfamiliar equipment's origin and condition on an INT test DC 12
- **Xenologist:** Advantage on INT/WIS tests concerning non-human life, language, and artefacts. Once per long rest, declare one true thing about a creature or artefact you're examining
- **Corpsman:** Stabilise a dying character with no test. Once per short rest, ten minutes of care restores 1d6 + WIS HP. Works on most non-human physiologies at disadvantage
- **Marine:** No disadvantage with military weapons. Advantage on tests to hold formation, breach, or fight in low gravity
- **Salvager:** Advantage to assess wreckage, find the valuable thing in a hold, or judge whether a structure is about to fail
- **Broker:** Advantage on CHA to negotiate, appraise, or find a buyer. Once per adventure, name a contact at any station you've visited

*Talents:* **Break and Enter, Move Silently and Unseen, Silver Tongue, Athletics,** and **Languages** work as written in Appendix A.

## Inherent Aptitudes

Use Section 4's Inherent Aptitudes, read differently:

| Aptitude                        | Reads as                                                      |
|---------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Darkvision / NightVision</b> | Ocular implant, or a species evolved somewhere dim            |
| <b>Natural Armor</b>            | Carapace, subdermal plating, a synthetic chassis              |
| <b>Natural Weapons</b>          | Claws, spurs, integrated tooling                              |
| <b>Tough</b>                    | Heavy-worlder, gene-modified, or simply built for it          |
| <b>Small</b>                    | A low-gravity native, an engineered crew-form, a drone-body   |
| <b>Wings</b>                    | Only meaningful in low gravity or with atmosphere — say which |
| <b>Hard to Pin Down</b>         | Reflex modification                                           |

**Two Skill Aptitudes means baseline human.** One or more Inherent Aptitudes means you are something else — engineered, alien, augmented, or synthetic. Your keywords say which.

## Suggested Combinations

| Concept                   | Aptitudes                       |
|---------------------------|---------------------------------|
| <b>Ship's pilot</b>       | Pilot + Tech                    |
| <b>Salvage crew</b>       | Salvager + Void-Walker          |
| <b>Ship's doctor</b>      | Corpsman + Xenologist           |
| <b>Boarding marine</b>    | Marine + Athletics              |
| <b>Trader</b>             | Broker + Silver Tongue          |
| <b>Station rat</b>        | Break and Enter + Move Silently |
| <b>Synthetic</b>          | Natural Armor + Tough           |
| <b>Contact specialist</b> | Xenologist + Languages          |

## B2. Keywords

| Type         | Examples                                                                                        |
|--------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| What you are | Human, Spacer, Heavy-Worlder, Engineered, Synthetic, Uplift, Not From Here                      |
| Role         | Pilot, Medic, Marine, Engineer, Broker, Surveyor, Chaplain, Indentured                          |
| Background   | Born In Transit, Corporate Contract, Colony Failed, Ex-Navy, Debt To The Company, Sole Survivor |

## B3. Gear Packs

All packs include a **vac suit**, a **comm**, and **2d6+5 credits**.

| Pack     | Contents                                                                          |
|----------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Deck     | Suit liner (+1 AC, 2 slots), sidearm (d6, 1 slot), multitool, torch, tether       |
| Boarding | Hardsuit (+3 AC, 5 slots), carbine (d8, 2 slots), breaching charge, tether        |
| Survey   | Suit liner (+1 AC, 2 slots), scanner, sample kit, beacon, rations (UD8)           |
| Salvage  | Suit liner (+1 AC, 2 slots), cutting torch (d6, 2 slots), prybar, patch kit, lamp |

## B4. Equipment

### Weapons

| Weapon         | Damage   | Slots | Cost (cr) | Notes                                                                              |
|----------------|----------|-------|-----------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Sidearm        | d6       | 1     | 400       | Near range, concealable                                                            |
| Carbine        | d8       | 2     | 700       | Far range                                                                          |
| Coilgun        | d8       | 3     | 1500      | Far range, piercing                                                                |
| Scattergun     | d10 / d6 | 3     | 600       | d10 at close, d6 at near, nothing beyond                                           |
| Pulse rifle    | d6       | 2     | 1200      | Far range, burst                                                                   |
| Marksman rifle | d10      | 3     | 3000      | Distant range, piercing. <b>Setup:</b> one round aiming, or attack at disadvantage |
| Cutting torch  | d6       | 2     | 200       | Close range. Cuts through a bulkhead given time                                    |
| Shock baton    | d6       | 1     | 150       | Close range. CON test DC 12 or lose next action                                    |
| Vibroblade     | d8       | 2     | 500       | Piercing                                                                           |

**Charge packs** run on a usage die — d8 for a loaded weapon, rolled once after each fight.

**A note on energy weapons.** They are not better than a rifle; they are a rifle with a different resupply problem. If your setting has both, let ballistics be cheap and repairable and let energy weapons recharge anywhere there's power. That trade is more interesting than a bigger die.

### Armour

| Armour     | AC | Slots | Cost (cr) | Notes                 |
|------------|----|-------|-----------|-----------------------|
| Suit liner | +1 | 2     | 500       | Worn under a vac suit |



| Armour      | AC | Slots | Cost (cr) | Notes                                              |
|-------------|----|-------|-----------|----------------------------------------------------|
| Duty armour | +2 | 3     | 1200      | Disadvantage on stealth                            |
| Hardsuit    | +3 | 5     | 4000      | Vacuum-rated. Disadvantage on stealth and swimming |
| Helmet      | +1 | 1     | 300       | Required for vacuum                                |
| Riot shield | +1 | 1     | 400       | Can be sacrificed to absorb 15 damage              |

## Gear

| Item             | Cost (cr) | Item               | Cost (cr) |
|------------------|-----------|--------------------|-----------|
| Vac suit         | 800       | Tether, 50 ft      | 30        |
| Air, spare (UD8) | 100       | Mag boots          | 200       |
| Comm             | 100       | Cutting charge     | 400       |
| Scanner          | 900       | Patch kit (UD6)    | 80        |
| Datapad          | 300       | Med-injector (UD6) | 150       |
| Beacon           | 200       | Rations (UD8)      | 20        |
| Lamp             | 40        | Sample kit         | 200       |
| Multitool        | 60        | Prybar             | 30        |
| Slate, blank     | 30        | Drone, small       | 1500      |

**Writing medium and marking tool:** a blank slate is both, and runs a single UD8. Aptitudes that call for them — **Scribe**, among others — are satisfied by one.

## Craft

| Craft   | Cost (cr) | Notes                                 |
|---------|-----------|---------------------------------------|
| Shuttle | 60000     | Six passengers. Orbit to surface      |
| Hauler  | 250000    | Crew of four. 500 slots of cargo      |
| Rover   | 20000     | Surface only. Four passengers         |
| Skiff   | 15000     | Two passengers. In-system, short hops |

## B5. Optional Rules

**Vacuum.** No suit means a CON test DC 12 each round. Failure costs 1d6 HP and you're unconscious on the second failure. A holed suit runs its air on a UD6 instead of a UD8, and the sound of it is the best pressure a GM has.

**Low and zero gravity.** In low gravity, jumps and lifts get advantage and anything requiring traction gets disadvantage. In zero gravity, you move only by pushing off something — plan your route or drift. **Void-Walker** cancels the disadvantage.

**Radiation and exposure.** Treat as a condition per Section 5. Severity 4-6d6 depending on source, resisted with CON, and it doesn't stop when you leave the room.

**Distance.** Nothing kills a science fiction campaign faster than instant travel. Give every journey a duration in days and roll for one complication en route. A crew that can't simply leave is a crew with problems.

## B6. Tone Notes

### The information problem

Science fiction has fantasy's problem in reverse: the characters have databases, sensors, and comms, and can in principle look up anything. Left alone, that dissolves improvised play the same way a phone does. The answers here are better than modern's, because the setting hands them to you:

- **Light-lag and distance.** A query to the nearest archive takes hours or weeks. You will decide before the answer arrives.
- **The database is corporate.** It contains what someone wanted in it. The redactions are the plot.
- **Nobody has been here.** Survey and salvage games are *built* on the absence of records. The scanner tells you the mass and the temperature; it does not tell you what the thing is.
- **The sensors work fine.** They report exactly what's there, and it makes no sense. This is the good one — trust the instruments and let the reading be the horror.

### Everything else

Keep it grubby. These rules give a starting character 10 + CON hit points and no shields, which means science fiction Rath is *Alien* and *Firefly*, not *Star Wars*. The ship needs repairs, the air is a resource, and nobody is coming.

Resist the technology arms race. The weapon list above tops out at the same d10 as a greatsword on purpose — the moment a plasma rifle does d12 because it sounds like it should, the fantasy appendix stops being playable at the same table and the whole structure of this book falls over. Make advanced technology interesting through *traits* and *logistics*, never through bigger numbers.

The strangeness in a science fiction game should be genuinely strange. A xeno that's just an orc with more arms wastes the setting. Ask what it wants, and make the answer something a human wouldn't want.

“““

## Quick Reference

### Tests

$d20 + \text{stat} \geq \text{DC } 12$ . Natural 20 = crit success. Natural 1 = crit failure.

### Combat Turn

Move (near) + Action, OR Run (far)

### Attack

$d20 + \text{STR/DEX} \geq \text{AC}$ . Damage explodes on max roll.

### At 0 HP

CON test DC 12. Pass = 1d6 HP and fight. Fail = out until danger passes.

### Rest

Short (1 hr): 1d6 + CON HP. Long (8 hr): Full HP.

### Leveling

Spend XP = current level. Gain aptitude at 3, 5, 7, 9.

**For advanced aptitudes:** See **Advanced Aptitudes** **For magic system:** See **Advanced Magic** **For GM tools:** See the **GM Handbook**